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MEMBERSHIP POLICY

International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc.

Edition	Revised edition (supersedes all prior versions)
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Approved by	Board of Directors of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc., Resolution No. 2026-01 dated November 11, 2026

1. Purpose of this Membership Policy

This Membership Policy sets out the official rules, requirements, membership categories, application procedures, application review standards, rights, obligations, benefits, limitations, renewal principles and conditions of membership status applicable to members of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc. ("IBPA" or the "Association").

This Policy is intended to:

- define the Association's membership categories;
- clarify who may apply for membership;
- establish a selective, review-based membership system;
- define the rights and obligations of members;
- set out the benefits and limitations associated with each membership category;
- ensure consistency between the Association's website, the membership application form, the review procedures and the governing documents;
- protect the professional reputation, mission and integrity of the Association.

This Membership Policy must be read together with the Bylaws, the Code of Ethics, the Professional Standards, the Membership Application Review Procedure, the Membership Review Policy, the Membership Cancellation and Termination Policy and the Association's other governing documents and policies.

2. General Principles of Membership

2.1 Voluntary Membership

Membership in IBPA is voluntary.

2.2 Selective Membership

Membership in IBPA is selective and is not granted automatically to every applicant.

2.3 Review of Applications

All membership applications are subject to review by the Membership Review Board or another body authorized by the Board of Directors.

2.4 Professional Fit

Membership may be granted only to persons or organizations that, in the Association's judgment:

- have a professional connection to the beauty industry;
- are aligned with the Association's mission and values;
- meet the requirements of the selected membership category.

2.5 No Automatic Right to Membership

Submitting an application, paying a fee or having professional experience does not create an automatic right to membership.

2.6 Membership in Good Standing

Only persons or organizations whose membership is:

- active,
- not suspended,
- not terminated, and
- compliant with the Association's requirements

are considered members in good standing.

3. Membership Categories

The Association recognizes the following official membership categories:

3.1 Specialist Membership

For emerging specialists who are at the start of their professional path in the beauty industry.

3.2 Professional Membership

For practicing beauty industry professionals.

3.3 Trainer / Educator Membership

For educators, trainers, mentors, schools and educational platforms.

3.4 Business Owner Membership

For owners or managers of beauty businesses, including salons, studios, academies and other beauty industry ventures.

3.5 Brand / Company Membership

For brands, companies, manufacturers, distributors, suppliers and service companies in the beauty industry.

4. Membership Fees

Unless otherwise determined by the Association, membership fees are as follows:

- Specialist Membership — $49
- Professional Membership — $199
- Trainer / Educator Membership — $399
- Business Owner Membership — $599
- Brand / Company Membership — $1,299

The Association reserves the right to change membership fees by decision of the Board of Directors.

Changes apply to future membership periods unless otherwise stated.

5. Eligibility for Membership

5.1 General Requirements

An applicant may be admitted to membership if he or she:

- has a professional, educational or business connection to the beauty industry;
- provides accurate and complete information in the application;
- meets the requirements of the selected category;
- agrees to comply with the Association's governing documents and policies;
- meets any additional requirements of the Membership Review Board.

5.2 Minimum Age

Applicants must be at least 18 years of age, unless otherwise permitted by the Association's rules for the Specialist category.

5.3 Supporting Documents

The Association may request documents confirming the applicant's professional activity, including:

- diplomas;
- certificates;
- licenses;
- confirmation of training;
- a portfolio;
- links to professional profiles;
- business registration documents;
- company materials;
- publications;
- professional references;
- other documents needed for the evaluation.

5.4 Additional Information

The Association may request additional information at any stage of the application review.

6. Requirements by Category

6.1 Specialist Membership

A specialist may be granted membership if he or she:

- is studying in a beauty industry program;
- demonstrates a serious interest in the profession;
- provides confirmation of training where required.

6.2 Professional Membership

May be granted to an applicant who:

- actively works in the beauty industry;
- has professional experience;
- provides a portfolio or confirmation of professional activity.

6.3 Trainer / Educator Membership

May be granted to an applicant who:

- trains beauty industry professionals;
- conducts trainings or courses;
- has teaching or mentoring experience.

6.4 Business Owner Membership

May be granted to an applicant who:

- owns or manages a beauty business;
- can confirm a connection to an operating business.

6.5 Brand / Company Membership

May be granted to a company that:

- operates in the beauty industry;
- has a registered brand or business;
- provides information about the company.

7. Selective Nature of Membership

7.1 Membership Is Selective

IBPA is a professional association with selective membership.

7.2 Evaluation Criteria

The review of an application may take into account:

- professional experience;
- years in the field;
- education;
- certificates;
- portfolio quality;
- professional achievements;
- contribution to the industry;
- teaching activity;
- participation in events;
- professional reputation;
- alignment with the Association's mission.

7.3 Category-Specific Criteria

Different evaluation criteria may apply to different categories.

7.4 No Obligation to Admit

The Association is not obliged to admit every applicant.

8. Application Process

8.1 Submitting an Application

The applicant must complete the official application form and provide the required documents.

8.2 Accuracy of Information

All information must be truthful and complete.

8.3 Review of the Application

The application is reviewed by the Membership Review Board in the manner and within the timelines set by the Membership Review Policy, using the methodology of the Membership Application Review Procedure.

8.4 Additional Requests

The Review Board may request additional documents; such a request suspends the review period until the documents are received.

8.5 Outcome of the Review

An application may receive one of the following statuses:

- Approved;
- Pending Additional Information;
- Deferred;
- Denied.

8.6 Payment

Payment is made after the application has been approved.

8.7 Activation of Membership

Membership is activated after:

- approval of the application;
- payment of the fee;
- entry in the register of members.

9. Members' Rights

Members may:

- state their IBPA membership;
- receive the benefits of their category;
- participate in events;
- use educational materials;
- take part in networking;
- submit proposals;
- voluntarily cancel their membership.

Membership does not guarantee:

- positions;
- committee participation;

- awards;
- speaking engagements;
- publications.

10. Members' Obligations

Members must:

- comply with the Bylaws, the Code of Ethics and the Professional Standards;
- provide accurate information;
- maintain their professional reputation;
- use their membership status properly;
- not damage the Association's reputation;
- cooperate with reviews and inquiries;
- pay membership fees on time;
- keep their profile information up to date.

11. Membership Benefits

Specialist Member

- Specialist Member status
- basic educational materials
- access to news
- participation in selected events
- digital certificate

Professional Member

- Professional Member status
- access to educational materials
- participation in events
- directory listing
- networking
- certificate

Trainer / Educator Member

All benefits of the Professional category, plus:

- participation in educational initiatives
- speaking opportunities
- extended profile

Business Owner Member

All benefits of the Professional category, plus:

- extended business profile
- business resources
- participation in business initiatives

Brand / Company Member

- Brand Member status
- brand profile
- participation in partnerships
- access to a professional audience

12. Comparison Table

The Association may publish package comparison tables.

If there are differences between a promotional description and this Policy, this document prevails.

13. Certificates and Badges

The Association may issue:

- membership certificates;
- digital badges.

Members may not use them:

- after their membership ends;
- in a misleading way;
- without the Association's permission.

14. Member Directory

The Association may maintain a Member Directory.

A directory listing may include:

- name;
- category;
- specialization;
- country or state;
- description;
- links;
- member status.

The Association may remove a listing in the event of:

- the end of membership;
- violations;
- inaccurate information.

15. Membership Term and Renewal

Membership is valid for the established period.

Renewal may require:

- payment;
- updated information;
- compliance with the standards.

Renewal is not automatic.

16. Cancellation of Membership

A member may cancel membership:

- through the personal account; or
- by writing to the Association at support@ibpassociations.org.

After cancellation:

- access to benefits ends;
- the profile may be removed.

All refund rules are governed by the Membership Cancellation and Termination Policy.

17. Suspension and Termination of Membership

Membership may be terminated in the event of:

- false information;
- violation of the Code of Ethics;
- violation of the Professional Standards;
- damage to the Association's reputation;
- non-payment of fees;
- refusal to cooperate with a review;
- failure to meet the category requirements.

A decision to suspend or terminate membership may be appealed in accordance with Article 14 of the Bylaws.

18. Transfer of Membership

Membership is personal and may not be transferred to third parties without the Association's permission.

19. Register of Members

The Association maintains an official register of members.

It may include:

- name;
- category;
- status;
- date of admission;
- renewal history;
- payments;
- contact details.

20. Public Descriptions

The Association may publish descriptions of membership on its website and in its materials.

If there are differences, this Policy prevails.

21. Relationship to Other Documents

This Policy applies together with:

- the Bylaws;
- the Code of Ethics;
- the Professional Standards;
- the Membership Application Review Procedure;
- the Membership Review Policy;
- the Membership Agreement;
- the Membership Cancellation and Termination Policy;
- the Conflict of Interest Policy;
- the Terms of Use and the Privacy Policy.

In the event of a conflict, the Bylaws prevail.

22. Amendments

This Policy may be amended by decision of the Board of Directors.

23. Official Language

The official version of this Policy is maintained in English. Any translation is provided for convenience only. In the event of any discrepancy, the English version prevails.